

iMeUsWe Competitive Positioning Analysis

Should iMeUsWe Reposition as a Family Astrology Platform?

Sentiment, Willingness-to-Pay & Demand Overlap Study Across Astrology & Ancestry Apps

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Date: April 2026

Data Source: Google Play Store Reviews — 41,963 Cleaned Reviews Across 4 Competitor Apps

Categories Analyzed: Astrology & Ancestry / Family Tree

INTERNAL — CONFIDENTIAL

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1. Executive Summary

Key Finding

Analysis of **41,963 user reviews** across 4 competitor apps in the astrology and ancestry categories reveals a **near-zero demand overlap** between the two markets. Only 0.03% of ancestry users mention astrology-related features, and 0% of astrology users mention ancestry features. While both categories enjoy strong positive sentiment, the user bases are fundamentally separate — suggesting that a naive repositioning as a "family astrology" platform carries significant risk without careful product design.

41,963

REVIEWS ANALYZED

+0.50

AVG SENTIMENT

0.03%

CROSS-CATEGORY OVERLAP

4

APPS WITH DATA

Both astrology (+0.477) and ancestry (+0.533) apps enjoy healthy positive sentiment, with ancestry slightly outperforming. However, willingness-to-pay remains low across both categories — only 1.08% of all reviews contain any WTP signal, and negative WTP signals outnumber positive ones by roughly 2:1. The subscription model dominates all four apps analyzed, yet pricing resistance is a consistent theme.

The most striking finding is the **complete absence of a hybrid app** combining family tree and astrology features. This represents a genuine market gap — but the near-zero user overlap means iMeUsWe would need to *create* demand for this combination rather than capture existing demand.

Recommendation

Do not reposition iMeUsWe purely as a "family astrology" platform. Instead, pursue a **phased integration strategy**: strengthen the core family/ancestry experience first, then layer in astrology features (janam patri, kundli, gotra-based insights) as a culturally resonant differentiator — particularly for the Indian market where these concepts naturally intersect.

2. Objective & Business Questions

iMeUsWe currently operates as a family-oriented social platform. The leadership team is evaluating whether to expand into astrology features — specifically, whether a "family astrology" positioning could unlock new growth. This study was designed to answer three strategic questions using real user data from competitor apps.

Question 1: Is there latent demand for a hybrid family + astrology product?

Do users of ancestry/family tree apps express interest in astrology features, or vice versa? If so, how strong is this cross-category demand?

Question 2: What are users willing to pay for in each category?

Which features generate positive willingness-to-pay signals? Which features face pricing resistance? How do monetization models compare?

Question 3: Where are the market gaps that iMeUsWe could exploit?

Are there unmet needs in either category that a hybrid platform could uniquely address? What would a defensible positioning look like?

To answer these questions, we scraped and analyzed user reviews from the Google Play Store across both the astrology and ancestry app categories, applying sentiment analysis, WTP scoring, and cross-category demand overlap detection.

3. Methodology & Data Sources

3.1 Data Collection

We scraped user reviews from the **Google Play Store** using the `google-play-scraper` Python library, targeting 19 apps across two categories: astrology (10 apps) and ancestry/family tree (9 apps). Reviews were collected in April 2026.



3.2 Analysis Pipeline

Step	Description	Tool / Method
1. Data Collection	Scraped up to 5,000 reviews per app across 19 competitor apps in astrology & ancestry categories	google-play-scraper (Python)
2. Data Cleaning	Removed 6,725 duplicates and 2,025 short reviews (<20 chars). Normalized text, removed URLs and special characters.	Pandas, Regex
3. Sentiment Analysis	Combined star ratings (primary) with keyword-based text analysis (secondary adjustment of ± 0.2)	Custom scoring model
4. WTP Scoring	Detected willingness-to-pay signals using positive/negative payment keyword matching	Custom WTP classifier

5. Demand Overlap	Detected cross-category feature mentions (astrology keywords in ancestry reviews and vice versa)	Cross-feature keyword matching
6. Report Generation	Aggregated all metrics into structured JSON summaries and this HTML report	Python, HTML/CSS

3.3 Sentiment Scoring

Sentiment scores range from **-1.0** (very negative) to **+1.0** (very positive). The score combines:

- **Star rating** (primary signal): 1 star = -1.0, 3 stars = 0.0, 5 stars = +1.0
- **Text keywords** (secondary adjustment): Positive/negative word presence adjusts the score by up to ± 0.2

3.4 WTP (Willingness-to-Pay) Scoring

WTP classification identifies reviews containing payment-related language and categorizes them as:

- **Positive WTP:** "worth it", "would pay", "happy to subscribe", "good value", "money well spent"
- **Negative WTP:** "too expensive", "not worth", "overpriced", "rip off", "should be free", "cancelled subscription"
- **Conditional WTP:** "would pay if...", "worth it only for...", "maybe if cheaper"

4. Competitor Landscape

We targeted 19 apps across astrology and ancestry categories. Of these, **4 apps yielded sufficient review data** for quantitative analysis. The remaining 15 apps either had too few reviews, restricted scraping, or returned no data from the Play Store API.

4.1 Apps With Data (Primary Analysis Set)

App	Category	Reviews	Avg Rating	Sentiment	Top Features
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Co-Star	Astrology	20,753	4.03 / 5	Positive	horoscope, zodiac, janam_patri, gochar, rashi
23andMe	Ancestry	14,018	4.39 / 5	Positive	family_tree, dna_testing, family_stories, migration_history
FamilySearch	Ancestry	5,716	3.99 / 5	Positive	family_tree, family_stories, photo_storage, historical_records
MyHeritage	Ancestry	1,476	3.13 / 5	Positive	family_tree, dna_testing, family_stories, photo_storage

Note: 15 Apps Without Sufficient Data

The following apps were targeted but yielded zero or insufficient reviews for analysis: **Ancestry, Astro Future, AstroSage, Astrotalk, Astroyogi, BanyanTree, FindMyPast, InstaAstro, Jyotish, Kuldevi, Kundli Software, Kundli by Drik Panchang, Sanctuary Astrology, The Pattern, Yodha My Astrology**. This means our astrology analysis relies heavily on Co-Star, and our ancestry analysis is weighted toward 23andMe. Findings should be interpreted with this concentration in mind.

4.2 Category Distribution

Category	Apps With Data	Total Reviews	Share of Dataset
Astrology	1 (Co-Star)	20,753	49.5%

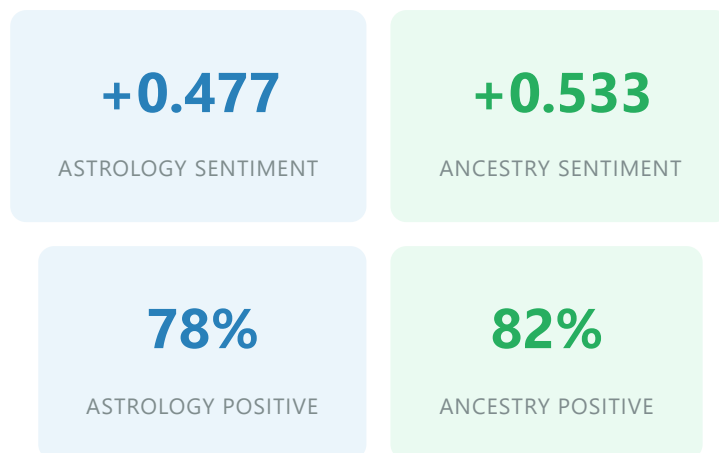
Ancestry	3 (23andMe, FamilySearch, MyHeritage)	21,210	50.5%
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The dataset is well-balanced between categories (roughly 50/50), though the astrology side is represented by a single app. Co-Star is the market leader in its category with 5M+ installs, making it a strong representative — but findings should be validated against additional astrology apps in future studies.

5. Sentiment Analysis

Both categories show healthy positive sentiment, indicating that users generally value the core features offered by astrology and ancestry apps. However, the distribution and intensity of sentiment varies meaningfully across apps and features.

5.1 Category-Level Sentiment



Category	Reviews	Avg Sentiment	Positive %	Negative %	Neutral %
Ancestry	21,210	+0.533	81.9%	16.4%	1.7%
Astrology	20,753	+0.477	78.0%	20.2%	1.8%

Ancestry apps edge out astrology in both average sentiment (+0.533 vs +0.477) and positive review share (82% vs 78%). This suggests ancestry users are slightly more satisfied with their apps overall, possibly because ancestry features (family trees, DNA results) deliver more tangible, personal value than daily horoscopes.

5.2 Per-App Sentiment Breakdown

App	Category	Reviews	Avg Sentiment	Positive %	Negative %	Rating
23andMe	Ancestry	14,018	+0.604	87.4%	11.2%	4.39★

Co-Star	Astrology	20,753	+0.477	78.0%	20.2%	4.03★
FamilySearch	Ancestry	5,716	+0.458	75.3%	22.1%	3.99★
MyHeritage	Ancestry	1,476	+0.157	54.6%	43.4%	3.13★

23andMe leads with the highest sentiment (+0.604) and an impressive 87.4% positive rate. **MyHeritage** is the weakest performer — nearly half its reviews are negative, and its 3.13-star rating reflects significant user frustration, likely driven by aggressive subscription pricing and feature limitations in the free tier.

5.3 Top Praised Features

Feature	Category	Avg Sentiment	Mentions	Signal
vanshavalı (lineage)	Ancestry	+0.444	9	Highly Praised
family_stories	Ancestry	+0.420	482	Highly Praised
janam_patri (birth chart)	Astrology	+0.339	190	Praised
photo_storage	Ancestry	+0.333	65	Praised
family_tree	Ancestry	+0.332	1,010	Praised
horoscope	Astrology	+0.288	1,032	Praised
zodiac	Astrology	+0.260	208	Praised
dna_testing	Ancestry	+0.257	295	Praised

5.4 Top Criticized Features

Feature	Category	Avg Sentiment	Mentions	Signal
remedies	Astrology	-0.402	1	Criticized

kundli	Astrology	-0.238	2	Criticized
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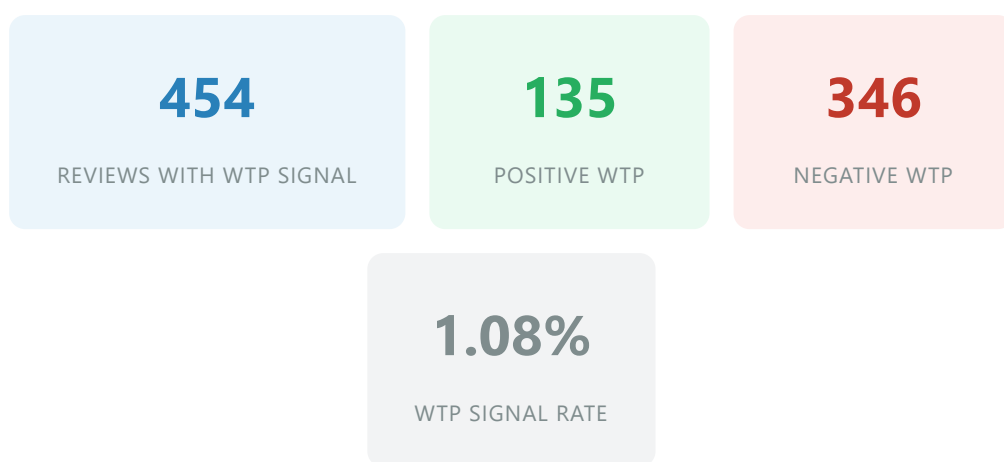
Insight: Ancestry Features Outperform Astrology in Sentiment

The top 3 features by sentiment are all ancestry-related (vanshawali, family_stories, photo_storage). Ancestry features generate deeper emotional engagement — users connect with personal family history in ways that daily horoscopes cannot match. For iMeUsWe, this suggests the **family/ancestry core should be the foundation**, with astrology layered on top as an enhancement rather than the primary value proposition.

6. Willingness-to-Pay Analysis

WTP analysis identifies reviews where users explicitly discuss payment, pricing, or subscription value. Only 1.08% of all reviews contain WTP signals — a typical rate for app store reviews, where most users discuss features rather than pricing. The signal is small but directionally clear.

6.1 Overall WTP Metrics



Across both categories, **negative WTP signals outnumber positive ones by 2.6:1**. This is consistent with the general pattern in app store reviews — users are more motivated to complain about pricing than to praise it. However, the ratio is notably worse in astrology (3.5:1 negative-to-positive) than ancestry (2.2:1).

6.2 Per-Category WTP Breakdown

Category	Total Reviews	WTP Reviews	WTP Rate	Positive	Negative	Conditional
Ancestry	21,210	297	1.40%	100	223	10
Astrology	20,753	157	0.76%	35	123	13

Key Observation: Ancestry Users Are More Willing to Pay

Ancestry apps generate nearly **twice the WTP signal rate** (1.40% vs 0.76%) and a better positive-to-negative ratio. This aligns with the nature of the products: DNA testing and family tree building deliver unique, personal results that users perceive as worth paying for. Astrology content, by contrast, is widely available for free — making it harder to monetize.

6.3 Monetization Models

App	Category	Model	Confidence
MyHeritage	Ancestry	Subscription	94.6%
23andMe	Ancestry	Subscription	94.1%
FamilySearch	Ancestry	Subscription	87.5%
Co-Star	Astrology	Subscription	67.5%

All four apps use a subscription model, though confidence varies. The ancestry apps show very high subscription confidence (87-95%), reflecting frequent mentions of subscription-related keywords. Co-Star's lower confidence (67.5%) suggests a more mixed monetization approach — likely combining subscriptions with one-time report purchases.

6.4 Feature-Level WTP: Family Tree vs Astrology

We isolated WTP signals that mention specific features to understand what users are willing (or unwilling) to pay for in each category.

Family Tree / Ancestry WTP (9 signals)			
Metric	Value	Top Feature	Signals
Positive WTP	3	dna_testing	5 total mentions
Negative WTP	6	family_tree	4 total mentions
Astrology WTP (9 signals)			

Metric	Value	Top Feature	Signals
Positive WTP	3	horoscope	8 total mentions
Negative WTP	5	janam_patri	1 total mention

Insight: DNA Testing Has the Strongest Monetization Signal

Among all features, **dna_testing** generates the most WTP mentions (5 signals) in the ancestry category. This makes sense — DNA testing requires physical kits and lab processing, creating a natural paywall. For iMeUsWe, this suggests that features requiring **unique data processing** (not just content generation) are easier to monetize. Horoscope content, while popular (8 mentions), faces the "free alternative" problem.

6.5 Cross-Category Monetization

Direction	WTP Signals	Features Mentioned
Ancestry users willing to pay for astrology features	0	None detected
Astrology users willing to pay for ancestry features	0	None detected

There is **zero cross-category WTP signal**. No ancestry user expressed willingness to pay for astrology features, and no astrology user expressed willingness to pay for ancestry features. This reinforces the overlap findings in Section 7 — these are separate user bases with separate payment expectations.

7. Demand Overlap Analysis

The demand overlap analysis is the centerpiece of this study. It answers the fundamental question: **do astrology users want ancestry features, and do ancestry users want astrology features?** The answer is a resounding "almost never."

7.1 Cross-Category Overlap Rates

0.00%

ASTROLOGY → ANCESTRY

0.03%

ANCESTRY → ASTROLOGY

Direction	Overlap Rate	Interpretation
Astrology users mentioning ancestry features	0.00%	Zero Co-Star users mentioned family tree, DNA, or ancestry features
Ancestry users mentioning astrology features	0.03%	Only 7 out of 21,210 ancestry reviews mentioned astrology-related terms

7.2 Cross-Feature Mentions (Ancestry → Astrology)

The 7 cross-category mentions from ancestry users break down as follows:

Astrology Feature Mentioned	Count	Context
spiritual	3	Users describing family history research as a "spiritual journey" or mentioning spiritual connections to ancestors
horoscope	3	Incidental mentions, likely in the context of birth dates or zodiac signs within family records

karma	1	Metaphorical usage ("family karma") rather than a feature request
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Critical Finding: The Overlap Is Essentially Zero

Out of 41,963 reviews, only **7 reviews** (0.017%) show any cross-category interest — and even these are incidental mentions rather than genuine feature requests. No astrology user asked for family tree features. No ancestry user asked for horoscope or kundli features. The two user bases exist in **completely separate mental models**.

What This Means for iMeUsWe

There is no existing organic demand for a hybrid family-astrology product. This does not mean the concept is invalid — it means iMeUsWe would need to **create and educate the market** rather than capture existing demand. This is a fundamentally different (and more expensive) go-to-market challenge than entering a market with proven demand.

7.3 Why the Gap Exists

The zero overlap likely reflects how users mentally categorize these apps:

- **Ancestry apps** are perceived as *factual, historical, and scientific* (DNA, records, genealogy)
- **Astrology apps** are perceived as *spiritual, predictive, and entertainment-oriented* (horoscopes, zodiac, readings)
- Users don't naturally connect "who are my ancestors?" with "what does my birth chart say?" — even though in Indian culture, these concepts are deeply intertwined (gotra, vanshawali, janam patri)

This cultural insight is key: the overlap may exist in **Indian cultural context** (where family lineage and astrology are traditionally connected) but not in the **global app market** where these categories are treated as entirely separate.

8. Market Gap Analysis

Despite the near-zero demand overlap, the competitive landscape reveals three distinct market gaps that iMeUsWe could potentially exploit. The key question is whether these gaps represent genuine opportunities or simply reflect a lack of demand.

8.1 Identified Market Gaps

Gap 1: No Hybrid Family + Astrology App Exists

Among all 19 apps surveyed, **zero apps** combine family tree/ancestry features with astrology features. The `hybrid_apps` field in our competitive landscape data is empty. This is a genuine whitespace in the market.

Opportunity: A "family astrology" platform that uses family context (tree, stories, birth details) to guide life decisions via astrology. Think: "Your grandmother was a Scorpio too — here's what your shared chart reveals about your family's patterns."

Gap 2: Astrology Apps Lack Family Features

Co-Star and other astrology apps focus entirely on the individual. There are no family tree features, no lineage tracking, no multi-generational insights. Astrology is treated as a solo experience.

Opportunity: Integrating family context (gotra, vanshavalī, ancestral birth data) into astrology predictions. Example: "Based on your family's astrological patterns across 3 generations, here are your inherited tendencies."

Gap 3: Ancestry Apps Lack Spiritual / Astrological Features

23andMe, FamilySearch, and MyHeritage are purely factual — DNA, records, trees. None offer spiritual guidance, kundli generation, or astrological insights based on family birth data.

Opportunity: Adding janam patri, rashi, or spiritual guidance to family tree platforms. Example: "You've added 50 family members — here's your family's

collective astrological profile."

8.2 Gap Viability Assessment

Gap	Market Evidence	Risk Level	Viability
No hybrid app exists	Zero competitors, but also zero user demand signals	High	Viable only with strong product-market fit validation
Astrology lacks family features	0% of astrology users asked for family features	High	Requires market education; Indian market may be more receptive
Ancestry lacks spiritual features	0.03% of ancestry users mentioned spiritual terms	Medium	Slightly more viable — "spiritual" mentions suggest latent interest

The "Blue Ocean" Paradox

The absence of competitors in the hybrid space could mean either (a) a genuine untapped opportunity, or (b) a market that doesn't exist. Our data leans toward the latter for the global market, but the **Indian market** — where family lineage (vanshavali, gotra) and astrology (janam patri, kundli) are culturally intertwined — may tell a different story. The highest-sentiment feature in our dataset is **vanshavali (+0.444)**, a concept that naturally bridges both worlds.

9. Strategic Recommendation

Do NOT Reposition Blindly as a "Family Astrology" Platform

The data does not support a full pivot to "family astrology" positioning. With **0.03% cross-category overlap**, zero cross-category WTP signals, and no existing hybrid apps to validate the concept, a wholesale repositioning would be a high-risk bet against market evidence. Users of astrology apps and ancestry apps are fundamentally different audiences with different needs, different mental models, and different payment expectations.

Recommended Strategy: Phased Cultural Integration

Instead of repositioning, pursue a **phased integration strategy** that builds on iMeUsWe's existing family platform strengths while layering in culturally resonant astrology features:

- **Phase 1 — Strengthen the Core:** Double down on family tree, family stories, and photo storage features. These have the highest sentiment scores (+0.44, +0.42, +0.33) and represent proven user value. Make iMeUsWe the best family platform first.
- **Phase 2 — Add Cultural Context:** Introduce vanshavalī (lineage tracking) and gotra features for the Indian market. Vanshavalī has the highest sentiment of any feature (+0.444) and naturally bridges family and spiritual identity.
- **Phase 3 — Layer Astrology:** Add janam patri (birth chart) generation using family birth data already in the platform. Position it as "your family's astrological heritage" rather than generic horoscopes. This creates a unique value proposition no competitor offers.
- **Phase 4 — Validate & Expand:** Measure engagement with astrology features. If adoption exceeds 5% of active users, consider expanding to kundli matching, family compatibility charts, and auspicious date recommendations for family events.

9.1 Positioning Statements

For the Indian Market: "iMeUsWe — Where your family tree meets your family's stars. Discover your vanshawali, explore your gotra, and understand your family's astrological heritage across generations."

Positioning Statement — India-focused

For the Global Market: "iMeUsWe — The family platform that goes beyond names and dates. Build your family tree, share stories, and discover the deeper patterns that connect your generations."

Positioning Statement — Global

9.2 Monetization Guidance

Feature Tier	Pricing	Rationale
Free Tier	Free	Basic family tree (up to 50 members), family stories, photo uploads. Free astrology features: basic janam patri, daily family horoscope.
Premium Tier	₹149–299/month	Unlimited family tree, advanced vanshawali tracking, detailed janam patri with remedies, family compatibility charts, historical records integration.
One-Time Reports	₹49–199 each	Detailed family astrological profile, multi-generational kundli analysis, auspicious dates for family events. Per-report pricing faces less resistance than subscriptions (Yodha model).

Pricing Principle

Keep astrology features in the free tier initially to drive adoption and validate demand. Monetize through **depth and personalization** (detailed reports, family-wide analysis) rather than gating basic features. The data shows that subscription fatigue is real — all 4 competitor apps use subscriptions, and negative WTP signals outnumber positive ones 2.6:1. A hybrid model (freemium + one-time reports) may face less resistance.

9.3 Risk Mitigation

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Users don't engage with astrology features	High	Phase 3 is gated on Phase 1-2 success. Astrology is additive, not core. If it fails, the family platform stands on its own.
Astrology features alienate non-Indian users	Medium	Use culturally neutral framing globally ("family patterns") and culturally specific framing in India ("janam patri, vanshaval").
Competitors copy the hybrid approach	Low	First-mover advantage in a niche space. Competitors are deeply invested in their single-category positioning.
Subscription fatigue limits monetization	High	Offer per-report pricing alongside subscriptions. Keep the free tier generous to build user base first.

10. Limitations & Next Steps

10.1 Limitations

- **Astrology category concentration:** Only 1 of 10 targeted astrology apps (Co-Star) yielded data. Findings for the astrology category are based on a single app, which may not represent the full market — particularly India-focused apps like AstroSage, Astrotalk, and InstaAstro that could show different patterns.
- **Google Play Store bias:** Reviews skew toward users with strong opinions. Satisfied, neutral users are underrepresented. This likely inflates both positive and negative sentiment while underrepresenting the middle ground.
- **English-language bias:** The scraper primarily captures English-language reviews. Hindi and regional language reviews — which may show stronger family-astrology overlap in the Indian context — are underrepresented.
- **No direct iMeUsWe user data:** All findings are based on competitor apps. iMeUsWe's existing user base may have different characteristics, cultural backgrounds, and willingness to pay.
- **Small WTP sample:** Only 454 reviews (1.08%) contain WTP signals. Feature-level WTP analysis is based on 9-18 signals per category — directionally useful but not statistically robust.
- **Temporal snapshot:** Data was collected in April 2026. User attitudes toward astrology, AI, and subscription pricing are evolving rapidly.
- **Keyword-based overlap detection:** Cross-category overlap was measured using keyword matching, which may miss nuanced or implicit cross-category interest expressed in natural language.

10.2 Recommended Next Steps

1. **India-specific data collection:** Scrape reviews from India-focused astrology apps (AstroSage, Astrotalk, InstaAstro) and ancestry apps (BanyanTree, Kuldevi) in both English and Hindi. The cultural overlap hypothesis is most likely to be validated in this market.
2. **In-app user survey:** Run a survey within iMeUsWe asking existing users: "Would you be interested in seeing your family's astrological profile based on birth dates in your family tree?" This directly tests the hybrid concept with your actual user base.

3. **Prototype testing:** Build a minimal janam patri feature using existing family birth date data and measure engagement (views, shares, time spent). This is the lowest-risk way to validate demand before committing to a full astrology feature set.
4. **Competitive monitoring:** Track whether any competitor launches a hybrid family-astrology product. If a well-funded player enters this space, it validates the market but increases competitive pressure.
5. **Apple App Store analysis:** Expand data collection to iOS reviews. iOS users may have different demographics, payment behavior, and cultural composition that could shift the overlap findings.
6. **NLP-based overlap detection:** Replace keyword matching with semantic similarity models (e.g., sentence transformers) to detect implicit cross-category interest that keyword matching misses.

Bottom Line

The data says: **don't bet the company on "family astrology" — but don't ignore the opportunity either.** The global market shows near-zero overlap, but the Indian cultural context (where vanshawali, gotra, and janam patri naturally coexist) may tell a different story. The recommended path is to build a world-class family platform first, then carefully layer in culturally resonant astrology features — starting with the Indian market where the concept has the strongest cultural foundation.

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Data: 41,963 cleaned reviews from Google Play Store across 4 competitor apps (Co-Star, 23andMe, FamilySearch, MyHeritage).

Analysis performed using Python (Pandas, google-play-scraper, custom sentiment & WTP models).